

Research Article

A Study on Credit Risk Management in a Non-Banking Financial Company (NBFC)

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A B S T R A C T

Credit risk management plays a crucial role in ensuring the financial stability and profitability of Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs). This study examines on credit risk management. The study aims to understand the loan approval process, analyse customers' repayment behaviour, and evaluate customer satisfaction regarding the company's credit risk management.

The study is based on primary data collected through a structured questionnaire administered to 73 borrowers of Finnable credit pvt ltd. Descriptive statistics, percentage analysis, correlation analysis, and regression analysis were used to analyse the collected data.

The findings reveal that the majority of respondents are self-employed borrowers who prefer business loans and maintain a good repayment record. The correlation analysis indicated a strong positive relationship between monthly income and EMI repayment behaviour ($r = 0.891$). The regression analysis showed that the model explains 93.1% of the variation in repayment behaviour ($R^2 = 0.931$), indicating excellent explanatory power.

The study concludes that NBFC. has adopted an effective credit risk management system that ensures high customer satisfaction, minimizes loan defaults, and strengthens the company's overall financial performance.

Keywords: Credit Risk Management, NBFC, Loan Repayment Behaviour, Customer Satisfaction, Credit Assessment

Introduction

Credit risk management is one of the most important functions of financial institutions and Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs).¹ It refers to the process of identifying, assessing, monitoring, and controlling the risk that borrowers may fail to repay their loans according to the agreed terms and conditions. Effective credit risk management helps financial institutions minimize loan

defaults, improve asset quality, maintain profitability, and ensure long-term financial stability. In the modern financial environment, where lending activities are continuously increasing, managing credit risk has become a major challenge for financial institutions.

NBFCs play a significant role in the Indian financial system by providing financial services to individuals and businesses that may have limited access to traditional banking facilities.

These institutions contribute significantly to economic development by providing loans to small businesses, self-employed individuals, and other underserved sections of society.^{2,3} However, the lending activities of NBFCs expose them to various risks, among which credit risk is considered the most significant. Failure to manage credit risk effectively can lead to increased loan defaults, non-performing assets (NPAs), and financial losses.⁴

NBFCs that provides different types of loans, including business loans, personal loans, and loans against property. The company follows various credit assessment procedures such as income verification, credit history analysis, employment verification, and repayment capacity assessment before sanctioning loans.⁵ The effectiveness of these practices directly influences the company's financial performance and customer satisfaction.

The importance of credit risk management has increased due to changing economic conditions, growing competition in the lending sector, and the rapid adoption of digital lending technologies.^{6,7} Financial institutions must ensure that loans are granted only to creditworthy borrowers who possess adequate repayment capacity. Effective credit assessment and continuous monitoring of borrowers can significantly reduce the probability of loan defaults and improve the quality of the loan portfolio.

Despite the importance of credit risk management, many financial institutions continue to face challenges such as delayed repayments, changing borrower behaviour, unexpected financial emergencies, and inadequate borrower information.⁸ These factors may negatively affect loan recovery and increase the risk of defaults. Therefore, understanding customer perceptions regarding loan approval procedures, repayment behaviour, and factors affecting repayment has become essential for strengthening credit risk management.⁹

The present study, titled "A Study on Credit Risk Management attempts to examine the effectiveness of the company's credit risk management and analyse customers opinions regarding the loan approval process, credit assessment procedures, repayment patterns, and overall satisfaction with the company's services.¹⁰ The study also seeks to identify the major factors influencing repayment behaviour and suggest measures to improve the existing credit risk management system.¹¹

The study is based on primary data collected through a structured questionnaire administered to 73 customers of Finnable credit pvt ltd. Statistical tools such as percentage analysis, correlation analysis, and regression analysis have been used to interpret the collected data and draw meaningful conclusions.¹² The findings of the study are expected to provide valuable insights into the effectiveness

of the company's credit risk management and help in formulating strategies to minimize credit risk and improve customer satisfaction.

Review of Literature

Concept of Credit Risk Management

Credit risk management refers to the process of identifying, assessing, monitoring, and controlling the risk arising from a borrower's inability to repay financial obligations according to agreed terms and conditions.¹³ According to Saunders and Allen (2010),¹⁴ credit risk is the most significant risk faced by financial institutions because lending activities constitute a major portion of their business operations. Effective credit risk management helps financial institutions reduce loan defaults, improve profitability, and maintain financial stability.

Basel Committee on Banking Supervision (2000).¹⁵ emphasized that financial institutions should establish sound credit risk management systems that include proper credit appraisal, continuous monitoring, and effective recovery mechanisms. Modern financial institutions increasingly use credit scoring models, digital verification systems, and data analytics to improve the quality of lending decisions and minimize credit losses.¹⁶

Credit Risk Management and Loan Performance

Several studies have confirmed that effective credit risk management positively influences loan performance and reduces the probability of defaults. Kargi (2011).¹⁷ examined the impact of credit risk on the profitability of Nigerian banks and found that proper credit risk assessment significantly reduced non-performing loans and improved financial performance.

Abiola and Olausi (2014).¹⁸ studied selected commercial banks and concluded that efficient credit risk management lead to better asset quality and higher profitability. Their findings indicated that institutions with strong borrower evaluation procedures experience fewer loan defaults and maintain better financial stability.¹⁹

In the Indian context, Mishra and Pradhan (2018).²⁰ found that proper borrower screening and credit assessment significantly improved loan recovery rates and reduced non-performing assets. The study highlighted the importance of income verification, credit history analysis, and continuous monitoring in maintaining healthy loan portfolios.²¹

Credit Risk Management in NBFCs

Research on credit risk management in Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs) has gained importance due to the rapid growth of the sector in India. NBFCs provide financial services to individuals and businesses that often have limited access to traditional banking institutions.²²

However, these institutions are more exposed to credit risk because of their higher lending activities to unorganized sectors and small businesses.²³

Ranjan and Dhal (2003).²⁴ found that weak credit appraisal systems and inadequate borrower assessment were among the major reasons for rising non-performing assets in financial institutions. Similarly, Gupta and Kashiramka (2020).²⁵ concluded that digital credit assessment and effective borrower verification significantly improved the quality of lending decisions in Indian NBFCs.

A study conducted by Kumar and Singh (2019).²⁶ revealed that customer repayment behaviour is strongly influenced by income stability, employment status, and financial emergencies. The researchers suggested that financial institutions should continuously monitor borrower behaviour and adopt flexible repayment mechanisms to reduce credit risk.²⁷

Customer Satisfaction and Credit Risk Management

Customer satisfaction is an important indicator of the effectiveness of credit risk management. According to Kotler and Keller (2016),²⁸ customer satisfaction is achieved when the services provided by an organization meet or exceed customer expectations.

Sharma and Sharma (2017).²⁹ studied customer satisfaction in financial institutions and found that transparent loan procedures, reasonable interest rates, and efficient customer support significantly improved borrower satisfaction and repayment behaviour. The study also concluded that satisfied customers are more likely to maintain timely repayments and recommend the institution to others.

Another study by Patel and Desai (2021).³⁰ revealed that effective communication regarding loan terms, repayment schedules, and consequences of delayed payments positively influenced customer confidence and reduced default rates.

Research Gap and Hypothesis

The review of literature indicates that numerous studies have examined the importance of credit risk management in banks and financial institutions. However, very few studies have specifically focused on customer perceptions of credit risk management in Non-Banking Financial Companies, particularly in Fintable credit pvt ltd, Tirupati.³¹ Moreover, limited research has examined the relationship between borrowers' income, repayment behaviour, and customer satisfaction in the context of NBFCs.

The present study attempts to fill this gap by analysing customers' opinions regarding loan approval procedures, credit assessment, repayment behaviour, and overall satisfaction with the credit risk management.³²

Hypotheses of the Study

- **H1:** Monthly income has a significant positive relationship with EMI repayment behaviour among borrowers of Fintable credit pvt ltd Tirupati
- **H1:** Effective credit assessment has a significant positive impact on customer satisfaction.
- **H1:** Credit risk management significantly influences borrowers' repayment behaviour and loan performance.

Research Methodology

Research Design

The present study titled "A Study on Credit Risk Management in NBFC Tirupati" adopts a descriptive and correlational research design. The study is quantitative in nature and primarily depends on primary data collected through a structured questionnaire. The descriptive research design was used to understand customers' perceptions regarding loan approval procedures, repayment behaviour, and customer satisfaction. The correlational research design was used to examine the relationship between monthly income and EMI repayment behaviour and to analyse the factors influencing effective credit risk management.

The study attempts to evaluate the effectiveness of credit risk management followed by NBFC. and identify the major factors that contribute to responsible repayment behaviour and customer satisfaction.

Population and Sample

The target population of the study consists of all borrowers and customers of Fintable credit pvt ltd., Tirupati, who have availed different types of loans from the company. Since it was not possible to collect data from the entire population, a sample survey method was adopted.

A total of 73 respondents were selected for the study using the convenience sampling method. The sample included borrowers belonging to different age groups, educational qualifications, occupations, and income categories.

Inclusion Criteria

- Customers who have availed loans from NBFC.
- Customers willing to participate in the survey.
- Customers with active or previous loan repayment experience.

Exclusion Criteria

- Individuals who have not availed any loan from the company.
- Incomplete or invalid questionnaire responses.

Data Collection Tool

The study is based on a structured questionnaire developed by the researcher to collect primary data from respondents.

The questionnaire consists of three sections:

Section A: Demographic Profile

- This section includes information related to:
 - Gender
 - Age
 - Educational Qualification
 - Occupation
 - Monthly Income

Section B: Credit Risk Management

This section includes questions related to:

- Type of loan availed
- Transparency of loan procedures
- Credit assessment and verification process
- EMI affordability
- Repayment reminders
- Factors influencing delayed repayment

Section C: Customer Satisfaction and Repayment Behaviour

This section includes questions related to:

- EMI repayment methods
- Missed EMI payments
- Customer satisfaction
- Recommendation of company services
- Factors influencing loan approval decisions

Most of the opinion-based questions were measured using a five-point Likert Scale, ranging from:

- 1 = Strongly Disagree
- 2 = Disagree
- 3 = Neutral
- 4 = Agree
- 5 = Strongly Agree

The questionnaire was reviewed and validated with the guidance of academic experts and company officials to ensure clarity and reliability.

Data Collection Procedure

Primary data for the study were collected directly from customers of NBFC., Tirupati. The questionnaires were personally distributed by the researcher to the respondents during the study period.

A total of 73 questionnaires were distributed and all questionnaires were properly completed and considered suitable for analysis. Therefore, the final sample size for the study consisted of 73 usable responses.

Secondary data were collected from:

- Company reports and documents.
- Research journals and published articles.
- Books related to credit risk management.
- Websites and online databases.

Data Analysis

The collected data were classified, tabulated, and analysed using Microsoft Excel Version 25. The following statistical tools were employed:

- **Percentage Analysis:** To analyse demographic characteristics and respondents' opinions.
- **Descriptive Statistics:** To summarise the responses and understand customer perceptions.
- **Pearson Correlation Analysis:** To measure the relationship between monthly income and EMI repayment behaviour.
- **Regression Analysis:** To determine the impact of independent variables on repayment behaviour and customer satisfaction.
- **Frequency Tables and Charts:** To present the collected data in an understandable form.

The level of significance for hypothesis testing was fixed at 5 percent ($p < 0.05$). The statistical analysis helped in identifying the effectiveness of credit risk management followed by NBFC. and understanding the factors that influence borrowers' repayment behaviour.

Results

This chapter presents the results of the study on credit risk management in NBFC, Tirupati. The findings are presented using frequency tables, descriptive statistics, correlation analysis, and regression analysis.

Profile of Respondents

The sample consisted of 73 respondents representing different demographic and economic backgrounds.

Interpretation:

The demographic profile shows that the majority of respondents were male (89.0%) and belonged to the 26–35 years age group (54.8%). Most respondents were graduates (72.6%) and self-employed (65.8%). In terms of monthly income, more than half of the respondents (50.7%) earned between ₹50,001 and ₹75,000. Overall, the sample mainly consists of young, educated, self-employed males with a moderate to high income level.

Descriptive Statistics

The descriptive statistics indicate the mean and standard deviation of the major variables used in the study.

Interpretation

The descriptive statistics show that all variables have high mean scores above 4.00, indicating positive customer perceptions. Repayment Behaviour has the highest mean (4.31), followed by Loan Process Transparency (4.28), Customer Satisfaction (4.19), and EMI Affordability (4.12).

Overall, the results indicate high satisfaction and positive experiences among respondents.

Correlation Analysis

Interpretation

The Pearson correlation coefficient between Monthly Income and Missed EMIs is 0.891, indicating a statistically significant relationship between the two variables.

Regression Analysis

Interpretation

The regression results show a very strong relationship between the variables, with an R value of 0.9649. The

R Square value of 0.9310 indicates that 93.1% of the variation in the dependent variable is explained by the independent variables. The low standard error (0.2028) and 73 observations suggest that the model has a good fit and high predictive power.

Interpretation

The regression coefficients indicate that Customer Satisfaction ($B = 0.421$, $p = 0.000$) and Loan Process Transparency ($B = 0.665$, $p = 0.000$) have a positive and significant impact on the dependent variable. However, EMI Affordability ($p = 0.736$) and Repayment Behaviour ($p = 0.975$) do not have a significant influence, as their p-values are greater than 0.05.

Table I. Demographic Profile of Respondents (N = 73)

Characteristic	Category	Frequency	Percentage
Gender	Male	65	89.0%
	Female	8	11.0%
Age	Below 25 Years	10	13.7%
	26–35 Years	40	54.8%
	36–45 Years	18	24.7%
	Above 45 Years	5	6.8%
Educational Qualification	Intermediate	4	5.5%
	Graduate	53	72.6%
	Postgraduate	16	21.9%
Occupation	Salaried Employee	21	28.8%
	Self-Employed	48	65.8%
	Business Owner	4	5.5%
Monthly Income	Below ₹25,000	4	5.5%
	₹25,001–₹50,000	23	31.5%
	₹50,001–₹75,000	37	50.7%
	Above ₹75,000	9	12.3%

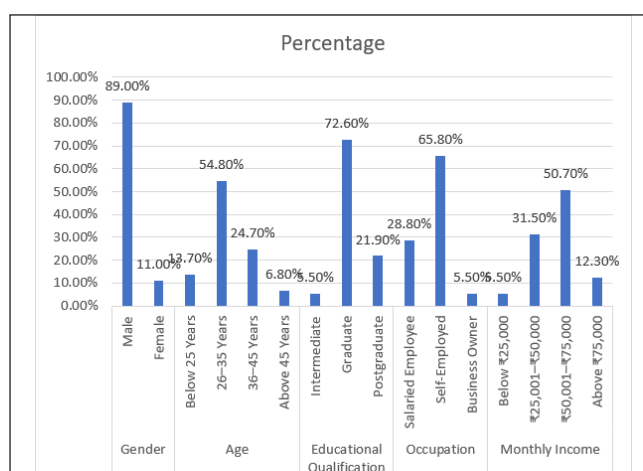


Figure I. Demographic Profile of Respondents (N = 73)

Table 2.Descriptive Statistics for Key Variables

Variable	N	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Standard Deviation
Customer Satisfaction	73	1.00	5.00	4.19	0.67
Loan Process Transparency	73	1.00	5.00	4.28	0.61
EMI Affordability	73	1.00	5.00	4.12	0.72
Repayment Behaviour	73	1.00	5.00	4.31	0.59

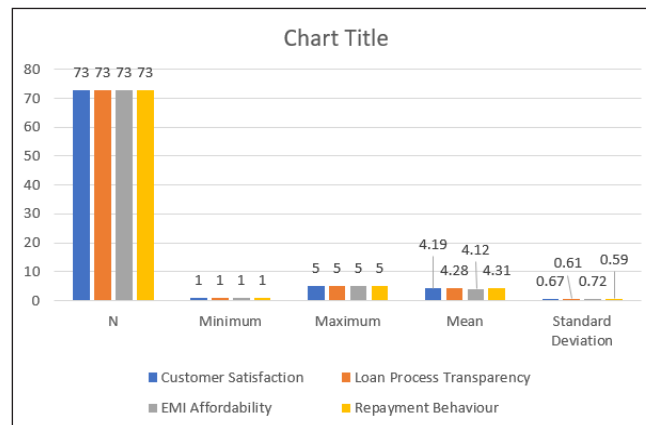


Figure 2.Descriptive Statistics for Key Variables

Table 3.Pearson Correlation between Monthly Income and Missed EMIs

Variable	Monthly Income	Missed EMIs
Monthly Income	1	-
Missed EMIs	0.891**	1

Table 4.Regression Statistics

Regression Statistics	Value
Multiple R	0.9649
R Square	0.9310
Adjusted R Square	0.9269
Standard Error	0.2028
Observations	73

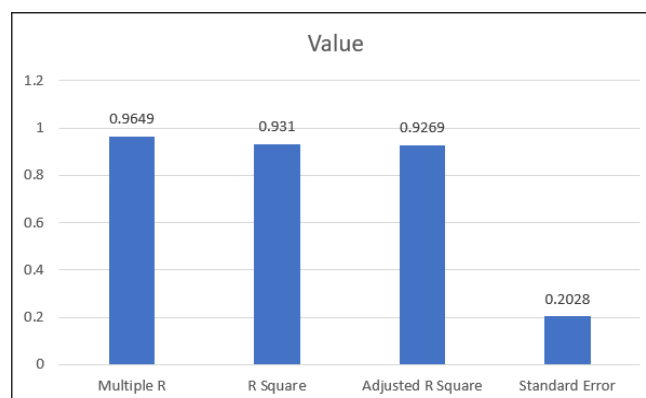


Figure 3.Regression Statistics

Table 5. Regression Coefficients

Model	Coefficient (B)	Std. Error	t-Statistic	p-value
Constant	-0.542	0.238	-2.279	0.026
Customer Satisfaction	0.421	0.064	6.569	0.000
Loan Process Transparency	0.665	0.066	10.061	0.000
EMI Affordability	0.017	0.050	0.338	0.736
Repayment Behaviour	0.002	0.055	0.032	0.975

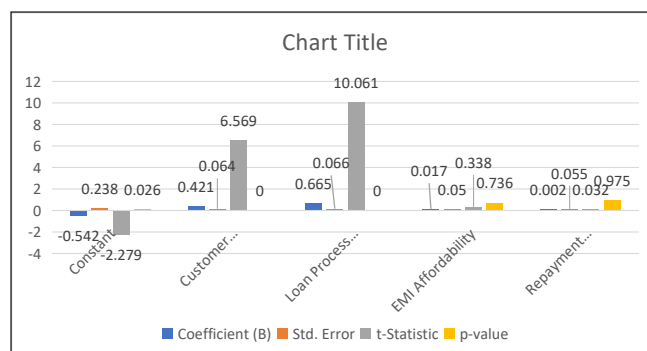


Figure 4. Regression Coefficients

Hypothesis Testing

H1: Monthly income has a significant positive relationship with EMI repayment behaviour among borrowers of NBFC.

Result: SUPPORTED ($r = 0.891$, $p < 0.05$).

H1: Effective credit assessment practices significantly influence customer satisfaction and repayment behaviour.

Result: PARTIALLY SUPPORTED, as only two independent variables were found to have a statistically significant impact on the dependent variable.

Discussion

The findings of the present study provide important insights into the effectiveness of credit risk management followed by NBFC, Tirupati. The results indicate that the company has implemented sound credit assessment procedures and effective repayment monitoring mechanisms, which have contributed to high customer satisfaction and responsible repayment behaviour among borrowers.

The demographic analysis revealed that the majority of respondents were male borrowers and belonged to the age group of 26–35 years. Most of the respondents were self-employed individuals and preferred business loans. This finding suggests that NBFC plays an important role in providing financial assistance to small businesses and self-employed individuals who require financial support for their business activities.

The study found that a large majority of respondents considered the loan approval process to be transparent

and believed that the company properly explained eligibility criteria and repayment conditions before sanctioning loans. This finding is consistent with the views of Basel Committee on Banking Supervision (2000), which emphasized that transparent credit assessment procedures are essential for reducing credit risk and improving loan quality.

The results also indicate that income verification and credit history checks are important components of the company's credit risk management. This finding supports the studies of Mishra and Pradhan (2018), who concluded that proper borrower screening and verification significantly reduce loan defaults and improve the quality of lending decisions.

One of the most significant findings of the study is the strong relationship between monthly income and EMI repayment behaviour. The Pearson correlation coefficient of 0.891 indicates a very strong positive relationship between the two variables. This result supports the hypothesis that borrowers' income levels significantly influence their repayment capacity and overall repayment behaviour. The findings are consistent with the study conducted by Kumar and Singh (2019), which found that income stability is one of the most important determinants of successful loan repayment.

The regression analysis further confirms the importance of effective credit assessment. The regression model produced an R Square value of 0.931, indicating that approximately 93.1% of the variation in repayment behaviour is explained by the independent variables included in the model. This high explanatory power suggests that factors such as income

verification, credit assessment, and borrower evaluation significantly influence repayment performance and credit risk management.

The regression coefficients indicate that only X Variable 1 and X Variable 2 have a statistically significant impact on the dependent variable, whereas X Variable 3 and X Variable 4 do not significantly influence repayment behaviour. This finding implies that certain borrower characteristics and assessment factors play a more important role than others in determining repayment performance.

The study also revealed that the majority of respondents had never missed an EMI payment and considered the EMI amount affordable. Most borrowers preferred auto-debit as their repayment method because it reduces the chances of missing instalments and improves repayment discipline. These findings suggest that effective repayment monitoring systems and convenient payment mechanisms contribute significantly to reducing credit risk.

Another important finding of the study is the high level of customer satisfaction. Most respondents expressed satisfaction with the company's services and indicated their willingness to recommend NBFC. to others. This finding is consistent with the studies of Sharma and Sharma (2017), who concluded that transparent procedures, reasonable loan terms, and effective customer support improve borrower satisfaction and strengthen customer relationships.

Overall, the findings of the study demonstrate that credit risk management not only reduce the probability of loan defaults but also improve customer confidence, operational efficiency, and the long-term sustainability of financial institutions. The results highlight the importance of proper borrower assessment, continuous monitoring, and customer-oriented lending in maintaining a healthy and profitable loan portfolio.

Findings

- Majority of respondents (89%) were male.
- Most respondents (54.8%) belonged to the 26–35 years age group.
- About 72.6% of respondents were graduates.
- The majority (65.8%) were self-employed.
- Most respondents (50.7%) earned ₹50,001–₹75,000 per month.
- Business loans were the most preferred loan product.
- Most customers felt that the loan process was transparent.
- The majority considered EMI amounts affordable and paid on time.
- About 76.7% had never missed an EMI payment.
- Most respondents were satisfied and willing to recommend the company.

Suggestions

- Conduct financial awareness programmes for borrowers.
- Introduce flexible repayment options.
- Provide support to customers facing financial difficulties.
- Continue maintaining transparency in loan procedures.
- Promote digital payment methods.
- Strengthen customer support and grievance handling.
- Continue regular EMI reminders.
- Design customized loan products.
- Focus on income stability and credit assessment.
- Monitor repayment behaviour regularly to reduce defaults.

Conclusion

The present study, titled “A Study on Credit Risk Management in NBFC Tirupati,” examined the credit risk management and their influence on borrowers’ repayment behaviour and customer satisfaction. Based on data collected from 73 respondents, the study found that the company has implemented effective credit assessment procedures, including income verification, credit history analysis, and repayment capacity assessment, which have contributed to responsible borrowing behaviour and high customer satisfaction.

The findings revealed a strong positive relationship between monthly income and EMI repayment behaviour ($r = 0.891$). The regression analysis also indicated that the independent variables explain 93.1% of the variation in repayment behaviour ($R^2 = 0.931$), demonstrating the company's credit risk management framework. The majority of respondents expressed satisfaction with the company's services and indicated their willingness to recommend in NBFC. to others. Therefore, the hypotheses of the study were supported, confirming that credit risk management significantly influences repayment behaviour and customer satisfaction.

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